



THEATRE

In God's Name

There was a time when the life-history of saints would be told to children by their family members. Later, the role was assumed by nautankis who would perform episodes from the Ramayana or Mahabharata. With the advent of TV, mythology became the subject of many serials. Nothing can, however, capture the pathos behind the stories better than drama. Substantiating this point will be four dramas presented by the Shriram Bharatiya Kala Kendra and directed by Shobha Deepak Singh from May 8 to 16. On May 8, the character of Karna as delineated by Vyas provides the most penetrating study of relations between man and his destiny, nature and nurture deemed and redeemed. On May 9, the life of Meerabai comes alive in the ballet *Meera*. On May 12, *Shree Durga*, born of the fire of consciousness, will be staged. On May 15 and 16, the erotic *Khajuraho* will be performed in a ballet based on Mayurbhanj Chhau. At Kamani Auditorium, Delhi.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

CONCERTS

The Glorious Dey

Poocho na kaise maine rain bitaayi... goes one of Prabodh Chandra Dey's (popularly known as Manna Dey) best remembered songs. The landmark song could well be a lament for the singer's life. Other famous songs include *Laga chunari mein daag* from the film *Dil Hi To Hai*, *Bhor aayi gaya andhiyaara* from *Bawarchi* and *Hato kaheko jhooti banao batiyan* from *Manzil*. While Mohammad Rafi, Mukesh and later Kumar ruled the roost, Dey was content singing melodies that were considered too difficult for the others. Though he stayed out of the rat race, his proficiency reflected in almost all his songs, such as *Ketaki gulab guhi*, which he sang with Bhimsen Joshi or *Ek chatura naar* with Kishore Kumar from *Padosan*. Adept at in Hindustani classical music and Rabindra Sangeet and having studied Baul music in his growing years, Dey also sang highly acclaimed songs in Marathi, Bengali and Malayalam. He has been honoured by the West Bengal and Kerala governments for his contribution to music, besides being conferred the Padma Shri and the Padma Bhushan. On May 1 this year, the legendary singer, who now lives in semi-retirement, turns 90. A tribute is being organised in

several cities. The first will take place in Bengaluru on May 10 and the other is scheduled for later in Kolkata, which will be organised by the Jadavpur University Alumni Foundation. The concert, titled 'Memories Come Alive', will take his fans on a musical journey spanning nearly seven decades of his life devoted to music. The three-hour concert will see the maestro in the company of classical singer Archana Udupa. At the Chowdaiah Memorial Hall, Bangalore.

by Nirmala Ravindran



MANNA DEY